UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 2008

GENERAL STUDIES : PAPER-I

Time: 2 hours **Maximum Number: 200**

ANCIENT HISTORY

1. What does Baudhayan theorem (Baudhayan Sulva Sutra) relate to?

(a) Lengths of sides of a right angled triangle
(b) Calculation of the value of pi
(c) Logarithmic calculations
(d) Normal distribution curve

Ans. (a) : Baudhayana Theorem (Baudhayan Formula) is related to the lengths of the sides of a right triangle. According to this theorem, the square on the hypotenuse of a right triangle is equal to the sum of the squares on the base and the perpendicular.

2. Near which one of the following cities are Palitana Temples located?

(a) Bhavnagar (b) Mount Abu
(c) Nasik (d) Ujjain

Ans. (a) : The Palitana temples of Jainism are located on Shatrunjaya by the city of Palitana in Bhavnagar district, Gujarat.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY

3. During the time of which Mughal Emperor did the English East India Company establish its first factory in India?

(a) Akbar (b) Jahangir
(c) Shahjahan (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (b) : During the reign of Mughal Emperor Jahangir, the English East India Company established its first factory in India at Surat. It is important in this regard that the Indian envoy of James I (then British Crown), William Hawkins (1608-11 AD) had requested to open a factory in Surat in the court of Jahangir. Jahangir allowed Hawkins to open the factory. However, Jahangir canceled permission after some time due to the opposition from the local merchants of Surat and the Portuguese. The British were again allowed to open the factory during the period of Thomas Roe (1615-18 AD), who came after Hawkins.

MODERN HISTORY

4. Which was the Capital of Andhra State when it was made a separate State in the Year 1953?

(a) Guntur (b) Kurnool
(c) Nellore (d) Warangal

Ans. (b) : Kurnool was the Capital of Andhra State when it was made a separate State in the year 1953.

5. Who among the following wrote the poem, Subhhe-Azadi?

(a) Sahir Ludhiyanvi
(b) Faiz Ahmed Faiz
(c) Muhammad Iqbal
(d) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad

Ans. (b) : Faiz Ahmed Faiz has written a poem called Subahe Azadi. He was born in Sialkot. After the partition of India, he remained in Pakistan. His main poetry collections are 'Dast-e-Saba' and 'Jindanama'.

6. Where was the First Session of the Indian National Congress held in December 1885?

(a) Ahmadabad (b) Bombay
(c) Calcutta (d) Delhi

Ans. (b) : First session of Indian National Congress was organized in the premises of Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit College, Bombay on 28 December, 1885 AD. This session was presided by Womesh Chandra Banerjee. A total of 72 delegates attended this session of Congress, mostly lawyers and journalists.It is noteworthy that the Congress was established in 1884 in the name of Indian National Union by A.O. Hume, which was renamed as the Indian National Congress in the session held in Bombay. The demands of the first session of the Congress mainly focused on administrative reforms and reduction in military activities.

7. Which one of the following was a journal brought out by Abul Kalam Azad?

(a) Al-Hilal
(b) Comrade
(c) The Indian Sociologist
(d) Zamindar

Ans. (a) : The Al-Hilal was a newspaper published by Indian leader Maulana Abul Kalam Azad and used as a medium for criticism of the British Raj in India. The newspaper also espoused the cause of the Indian independence movement and exhorted Indian Muslims to join the movement. The newspaper was shut down under the Press Act of 1914.

8. Who among the following Gandhian followers was a teacher by profession?

(a) A. N. Sinha
(b) Braj Kishore Prasad
(c) J. B. Kriplani
(d) Rajendra Prasad

Ans. (c) : Following his education at Fergusson College in Pune, Kriplani worked as a school teacher before joining the freedom movement following Gandhi's return from South Africa. He was a professor of English and History. Kripalani came in contact with Gandhi in 1917 during Champaran Satyagraha.

9. Who among the following translated the Autobiography of Madam Curie in Hindi?

(a) Atal Bihari Bajpayee
(b) Lal Bahadur Shastri
(c) Choudhary Charan Singh
(d) Gobind Vallabh Pant

Ans. (b) : The former Prime Minister of India, Lal Bahadur Shastri translated the autobiography of the inventor of radium, Madam Curie in Hindi.

10. Who among the following rejected the title of Knighthood and refused to accept a position in the Council of the Secretary of State for India?

(a) Motilal Nehru
(b) M. G. Ranande
(c) G. K. Gokhale
(d) B. G. Tilak

Ans. (c) : Gopal Krishn Gokhle rejected the title of Knighthood and refused to take office in the council of the secretary of the State for India. He was the founder of servant of India society and mentored Mahata Gandhi in his early years.

11. During the Indian Freedom Struggle, who of the following raised an army called 'Free Indian Legion'?

(a) Lala Hardayal
(b) Rashbehari Bose
(c) Subhas Chandra Bose
(d) V. D. Savarkar

Ans. (c) : In 1942, Subhash Chandra Bose recruited Indian prisoners of war captured from Rommel in North Africa and formed a team of 10 thousand soldiers and named it 'Free Indian Legion'.

12. Which one of the following suggested the reconstitution of the Viceroy's Executive Council in which all the portfolios including that of War Members were to be held by the India leaders?

(a) Simon Commission
(b) Simla Conference
(c) Cripps Proposal
(d) Cabinet Mission

Ans. (d) : In 1946 cabinet mission plan, the executive council was expanded to consist of only Indian member except the viceroy. The mission, the the Simla conference attempted to facilitate an agreement between the Muslim league and the congress. when this failed, the mission came out with its own proposals known as the cabinet Mission plan.

13. Who among the following gave a systematic critique of the moderate politics of the Indian National Congress in a series of articles entitled New Lamps for Old?

(a) Aurobindo Ghosh
(b) R. C. Dutt
(c) Syed Ahmad Khan
(d) Viraraghavachari

Ans. (a) : K.G. Deshpande, a friend of Aurbindo from his Cambridge days, was in charge of a weekly, "Induprakash", published from Bombay. He requested Sri Aurobindo to write upon the current political situation. Sri Aurobindo began writing a series of fiery articles under the title "New Lamps for Old", strongly criticising the Congress for its moderate policy.

14. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the Lists:

List-I (Author)	List-II (Work)
A. Bankimchandra	1. Shatranj Ke Khilari
B. Dinabandhu Mitra	2. Debi Chaudhurani
C. Premchand	3. Nil-Darpan
	4. Chandrakanta

Code

	A	B	C
(a)	2	4	1
(b)	3	4	2
(c)	2	3	1
(d)	3	1	4

Ans. (c) : Devi Chaudharani, Durgesh Nandani and Anand Math are famous works of Bankim Chandra Chatterjee. The story of Anand Math is based on the Sanyasi rebellion. Our national anthem Vande Mataram is taken from Anand Math. Neeldarpan is the creation of Deenbandhu Mitra. Its story is based on the Nile rebellion. Munshi Premchand is credited with the creation of famous works like Shatranj Ke Khilari, Buddhi Kaki, Godan, Gaban, Nirmala, Karmabhoomi etc. Chandrakanta is a novel by Devki Nandan Khatri.

15. Who among the following used the phrase 'Un-British' to criticize the English colonial control of India?